Payson's Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Fredas, the 6th of Sun's Dusk (Friday, November 6, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2611, No. 06 · Price: One Septim



Gandy holds the dry deck in lordly gloom while Maevy duels a runaway pine needle.

Skies O'er the Hold 57° / 45° Overcast

A grey, cool day — overcast skies, a steady breeze, and a chance of rain.

Wind 10 mph · Feels like 53° · UV 3 (Moderate) · Rain 12%

Sunrise 6:49 AM · Sunset 5:27 PM · Tomorrow — Overcast, 61/45

The Moon's Reckoning

Yesterday · Tonight (Waning Crescent) · Tomorrow

waning toward the new moon

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
52° Overcast 7 mph	56° Overcast 9 mph	53° Sunny 6 mph	47° Clear 6 mph

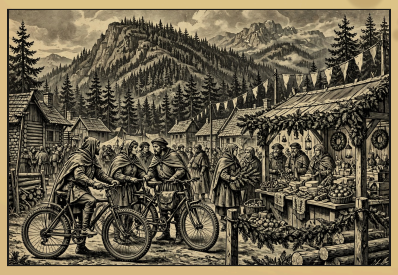
Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Fish Fries, Fast Bikes, and a Hold Full of Friday Merry-Making

Payson, Ariz.

Listen to this story

PAYSON — Hail, wayfarer, and pull your cloak close — Fredas dawns grey and cool over the Rim, with the pines standing quiet under a blanket of cloud and a fair breeze to hurry you along the road. The Holds are in fine Friday fettle: fish fries sizzle in Payson and Pine, Sedona's red rocks ring with the great Mountain Bike Festival all weekend, and Show Low serves soup in hand-made bowls for a good cause. Word from the road brings glad tidings, too — the first North Inch Renaissance Faire at the Payson Golf Course last month was such a success that its organizers are already planning next year's. By the Nine, there is plenty to do before the early 5:27 sunset — choose your adventure below.



Riders, market stalls, and merry folk gather under a grey Rim sky — the Holds open a full Friday of doings.

Happening in the Holds Today

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- **Payson**

  — **Payson Elks Lodge Friday Fish Fry** — 5:30–7:30 PM at the Payson Elks Lodge, 1206 N Beeline Hwy. The Lodge opens the big Howlin' at the Moon dual-sport weekend with its weekly Friday fish fry, and riders and locals alike are welcome at the table. Expect a home-style fried-fish supper in good company before Saturday's forest loops roll out. It is the easy way for Hearth guests to meet the rider crowd without throwing a leg over a bike. Come hungry and come early — lodge suppers fill fast on event weekends.

  — **Band of Fools at The Roadhouse** — live music Friday night, 8:00 PM to midnight, at The Roadhouse in Payson. After the fish fry, the town keeps its Friday going with a late set of live band fare for folks who like their evenings with a tune in them. Dinner first, then music — the classic small-town Friday, done properly. Check the Bandsintown listing or the venue for cover and seating before you head out. A fine nightcap for guests not ready for an early bed.

— **GrannyCore Christmas Sale** — an early Christmas sale running Friday and Saturday, Nov. 6–7, here in Payson (from the Hold's yard-and-estate-sales sheet). Think cozy, handmade, and vintage-leaning holiday goods — the kind of sale where the best treasures go to the early birds. It pairs nicely with Saturday's Noel Christmas Market at Noley's for a full weekend of gift hunting. If your hearth needs trimming before the season crowds arrive, this is your opening move. No web page stands for it — ask around town and follow the sale signs.

- **Pine-Strawberry**

— **First Friday Fish Fry and Bingo** — at the Pine Strawberry Community Center, 3916 AZ-87, Pine. Fish is served from 4:30 PM (plates $7/$12/$15, with homemade pie at $5), and bingo follows at 6:00 PM. This is the twin villages' social anchor of the month — neighbors, winter visitors, and Hearth guests all at the long tables together. Expect a community-center supper, bingo cards, and small-town prizes rather than a commercial show. Come for the fish, stay for the bingo, and bring a little cash for the pie.

- **Sedona**

— **Sedona Mountain Bike Festival** — Friday through Sunday, Nov. 6–8, 9:00 AM–7:00 PM, at Posse Grounds Park, 525 Posse Grounds Rd. One of the nation's premier mountain-bike festivals, with more than 90 vendors and more demo bikes than any other festival of its kind. Three days of demos, shuttled rides to 250-plus miles of red-rock singletrack, guided rides, and skills clinics for beginners through experts. Add live entertainment, food trucks, and a beer garden, and the whole park hums all weekend. New this year: a Shuttle-Only Pass for riders who just want maximum trail time.

— **1st Friday in the Galleries** — Friday, 4:00–7:00 PM, at galleries across Sedona, including Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village, 336 State Route 179. Sedona's galleries open together with new exhibitions, artist receptions, music, and treats — free and open to everyone. At Tlaquepaque, Mountain Trails Galleries launches a small-works show, and Creative Gateways paints live from a blank canvas. The Village Gallery in the Village of Oak Creek hosts its own reception from 5:00–8:00 PM. An easy, walkable evening — come and go from gallery to gallery as you please.

— **FAMoS First Friday Reception — Curt Walters: A Lifetime of Art** — Friday, 5:00–8:00 PM at the Sedona Heritage Museum, with a live interview at 5:45 PM. The Fine Art Museum of Sedona hosts this free reception for the Grand Canyon plein-air master, whose show gathers works painted after he moved to Sedona in 1979. Admission is free and refreshments are served. It is a quieter, sit-down counterpoint to the gallery stroll. Guests who love landscape painting should not miss it.

- **Show Low**

— **NPC Empty Bowls** — Friday, 11:00 AM–2:00 PM, at Northland Pioneer College's Show Low campus, Aspen Center Room 103, 1001 W. Deuce of Clubs. For a suggested $10 donation, you pick a hand-crafted ceramic bowl, fill it with soup donated by Persnikkity's plus fresh bread — and keep the bowl. Every dollar goes to the RE:center, a local nonprofit working on health, safety, and self-sufficiency. This year adds a plant and art sale for student scholarships. No reservations — first come, first served, cash or check at the door.

— **Fiber Arts Gathering at NPC** — Friday on the same Show Low campus, 1001 W. Deuce of Clubs. The college calendar invites one and all: "Interested in the fiber arts? Join us!" A drop-in makers' circle for knitters, weavers, and stitchers of every level. Pair it with the Empty Bowls luncheon for a full and friendly campus visit. Check the NPC calendar for the room and hour before you go.

- **Prescott**

— **Anthony Mazzella — Legends of Guitar** — Friday, 7:00 PM, at the Prescott Elks Theatre, 117 E. Gurley St. The acclaimed virtuoso plays every note live in a high-energy tribute to the world's iconic guitarists. Expect Hendrix, Clapton, Page, Gilmour, Harrison, Van Halen, and even Segovia in one solo show. The historic Elks Theatre on Gurley Street is half the pleasure — arrive early and soak it in. A strong Friday-night anchor for music lovers willing to make the Prescott drive.

— **Prescott History Tour** — Friday, 10:00 AM–12:00 PM, downtown Prescott, from Whiskey Row to Nob Hill. A guided two-hour walk through the landmarks of Arizona's original territorial capital, with the people and stories that shaped it. Daytime, outdoors, and easy-paced — a fine first introduction to Prescott for new visitors. The tour is run by Freaky Foot Tours; check the Signals AZ listing for the meeting point. Sturdy shoes and a curious mind are all you need.

The Days Ahead

Listen to this story

- **Sat, Nov. 7**

  — **Howlin' at the Moon Dual Sport Ride** — Saturday and Sunday at the Payson Elks Lodge, 1206 N Beeline Hwy. Arizona Trail Riders' two-day rally rides a 110–120 mile forest loop Saturday (check-in 6:00–8:00 AM) and shorter 50–60 mile loops Sunday, with breakfast at the Lodge both mornings and a home-cooked Elks dinner Saturday at 5:30 PM. Registration closed Oct. 26 and the listing marks it sold out — so print this as a spectacle, not a sign-up. The town will buzz with bikes all weekend, and the Lodge is the place to watch it gather. Rain or shine, the riders ride.

  — **Gila County Gem & Mineral Society Fall Show & Sell** — Saturday, 9:00 AM–2:00 PM, free admission, at Bullion Plaza, 150 Plaza Circle, Miami. Vendors sell gems, minerals, jewelry, and rough rock, with rockhounds and jewelry makers on hand to visit with — a small, friendly one-day show. Popcorn and water are sold on site, with food and coffee trucks alongside. Mind the early 2:00 PM close if you are driving down from Payson. A perfect Saturday prize for anyone who loves what the Rim is made of.

  — **Rim Country Marine Corps Ball** — Saturday evening at the Mazatzal Hotel & Casino, Payson. Marine Corps League Detachment #928's formal birthday ball: social hour at 5:00 PM, ceremony at 6:00 PM (no admittance during the ceremony), dinner at 7:00 PM, then a raffle and dancing. Tickets are $50 per person on the reservation form at rimcountrymarines.org. It anchors Payson's Veterans-week season in full dress style. Late ticket availability is not confirmed — call ahead before dressing up.

  — **Don't Sweat It, Shred It! — Free Shred Event** — Saturday, 9:00 AM–1:00 PM, at Camp Verde Town Hall, 473 S. Main St. AARP's free secure-shredding stop: sensitive papers do not belong in the recycling bin, so bring them for safe on-site shredding. It is a practical errand that protects against fraud, and it costs nothing. Pair it with a Camp Verde morning — Montezuma Castle or Fort Verde — and lunch after. Drive up, shred, and leave lighter.

  — **Noel Christmas Market at Noley's** — Saturday at Noley's Books, Art & Whatnot, 103 E. State Hwy 260, Payson. An early-season Christmas market at Payson's beloved book-bar and gathering place, carried from the Hold's own listings. Expect local makers, books, art, and holiday goods in Noley's cozy rooms. It makes a fine Saturday pair with Friday's GrannyCore sale for gift hunters. No web page stands for the market — check Noley's own page or just come by and see.

- **Sun, Nov. 8**

  — **The Thirsty Band at AZTEX Coffee and Taproom** — Sunday, 1:00 PM, in Show Low. A relaxed Sunday-afternoon live set at a coffee-and-taproom — the gentle end of a busy weekend. The band returns to the same room Friday, Nov. 13, so locals get two chances. Good low-key fare for guests overnighting in the White Mountains. Check the Bandsintown listing for cover and updates before going.

- **Mon, Nov. 9**

  — **United Food Bank — Payson Food Distribution** — Monday, 9:00–11:00 AM, at 601 AZ-260, Payson. A drive-through distribution of produce and pantry staples, listed in the Holiday Helpings roundup for families getting ready for Thanksgiving. The listing notes a turkey is not guaranteed at this stop — come for the groceries, not a promise. This is a know-where-to-send-folks item: pass the word to any neighbor who could use a hand. Volunteers and donations are the other way to take part.

- **Wed, Nov. 11**

  — **Prescott Veterans Day Parade** — Wednesday in downtown Prescott; opening ceremonies 10:30 AM at Cortez and Union, parade at 11:00 AM around Courthouse Plaza. This year's theme, from the City itself: "Remember the Past. Serve the Present. Inspire the Future." Entries compete in seven categories plus Best Overall, and the whole community is invited, free. Arrive before 10:30 for the ceremony and a good spot on Cortez Street. A worthy midweek drive for every guest who honors those who served.

Merchant of the Hold

Listen to this story

Ruby Road Vintage Mall · *Camp Verde*



Inside Ruby Road: sixty booths of treasures, and the furniture room is the stuff of legend.

Eight thousand square feet of treasure just off Highway 260 — more than 60 vendor booths of vintage and repurposed furniture, home décor, clothing, hand-poured candles, locally crafted jewelry, gourmet treats, and artisan goods. The furniture room is the signature hunt: hundreds of pieces, and the house rule is plain — drawers glide, hinges work, no holes. A whisper of an Appraisal enchantment hangs over the place, the regulars swear, for the right piece seems to find its traveler the moment he walks in.

> *"It's really fun to look around, plus it's clean, and it doesn't have that musky odor that some resale shops have"* — Flagstaff Business News, quoting customer and local artist Sheri Morris

851 E Howards Rd, Camp Verde — open seven days, 10 AM–5 PM; phone (928) 567-5759; $$ (moderate). Good to know: new furniture lands daily in the shop and online — call before driving down for a piece you spotted on their website. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: The Hearth sends guests here on the Camp Verde day — Montezuma Castle and Fort Verde in the morning, then one great treasure hunt where every traveler finds something to carry home.

Stories Around the Rim

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Ten Minutes Late at the Seven Thousand Steps



The seven thousand steps: boot prints, a warm bench, and the mist split in two — ten minutes after he was gone.

Word comes this week by a goatherd come down the high mountain road, and he swears every word of it. The grey monks at the shrine atop the seven thousand steps called a name into the storm last week — and this week, he says, the hooded one came.

Nobody saw him arrive, mind you. The goatherd reached the top not ten minutes after the shrine bell rang and found only this: a row of boot prints in the frost going up, a bench still warm, and the great bank of mountain mist split clean in two, as if a single spoken word had parted it like a curtain — and through the gap, a lost mule train coming safely down the far side, bells jingling, drivers none the wiser.

One monk says the stranger learned a word up there and spent it kindly on the road. Another monk says there was no stranger at all, only weather. Mabel doesn't believe a word of it, either way. But the boot prints were real, the goatherd swears — and both rows of them, up and down, were already fading when he bent to look.

Tales from the Treeline

Listen to this story

Mittens for the Antlers



Earl endures his antler mittens with enormous dignity; Jethro takes the spares as socks.

Fredas dawned grey and cool, and Mabel (a wood elf) looked out at the cloud blanket and declared it a knitting day. By mid-morning she had finished two tiny mittens — and then, eyeing Earl (an elk), she kept right on knitting.

"For the antler tips," she said, tying the first one on while Earl stood very still and tried to look like this was normal. "A dignified elk should not have cold antlers." Earl, who takes himself more seriously than any creature in the forest, bore it with enormous dignity, which is to say he pretended not to notice the mittens, the onlookers, or Henny (the Hearth's chicken) following him around making soft, impressed noises.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) wanted in, of course. There were not enough mittens for a monster, so he wore the spares as socks — one on each great foot — and paraded the clearing with his toes wiggling in striped wool. Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) offered to chill the mittens "for authenticity," and was voted down by everyone, including the mittens.

By evening Earl was still wearing his, purely, he said, because removing them would be undignified. Mabel has orders for six more pairs. The forest has never been warmer, or prouder.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Fredas be free of giants, the admin.

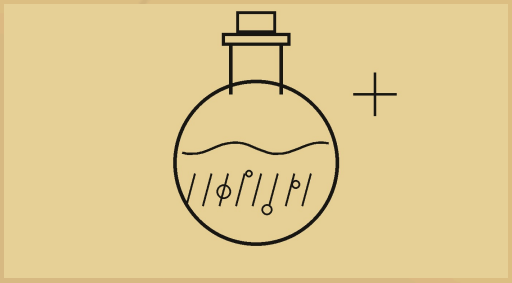
Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com

— Advertisement —

CURE DISEASE. RESIST FROST.

Impress Nords.



Elberta's Elixirs has a potion for every peril the Rim can pour: cure disease, resist frost, breathe water, and a courage tonic strong enough to make a skeever apologize.

Side effects include confidence, glowing slightly, and telling the truth at feasts. Two septims back on every empty bottle.

Elberta's Elixirs · Next to the apothecary, Payson Hold · Taste before you travel